

FEDERAL MARITIME COMMISSION
Office of the Administrative Law Judges

HEATHER MELEKA WILSON, *Claimant*

v.

TRANSPARENT INTERNATIONAL/TRANSPARENT LOGISTICS
INC., *Respondent*.

DOCKET NO. 2064(I)

Served: September 4, 2026

ORDER OF: Jamie L. MENDELSON, *Small Claims Officer*.

INITIAL DECISION¹

I. INTRODUCTION

This proceeding arises from a small claims complaint (“Claim”), filed by Heather Meleka Wilson (“Claimant”) against Transparent International/Transparent Logistics Inc. (“Respondent”), before the Federal Maritime Commission (“FMC” or “Commission”). Claimant paid Respondent, an ocean transportation intermediary, for an international shipment of Claimant’s household goods from Virginia Beach, Virginia, to Birmingham, United Kingdom. After Claimant’s household goods were picked up in Virginia by Respondent’s origin agent, Respondent never shipped the household goods onward to the United Kingdom. Instead, Respondent abandoned Claimant’s household goods in a warehouse and ceased all communication. As a result of Respondent’s failure to ship the household goods, Claimant ultimately paid another international moving company to recover the household goods from the warehouse and ship the household goods to the United Kingdom. Claimant alleges that Respondent has violated section 41102(c) of the Shipping Act, 46 U.S.C. § 41102(c), and seeks reparations for the amount paid to Respondent, the amount paid to the third-party international moving company to recover the household goods and ship them, and the costs in pursuing the Claim. Respondent has failed to respond to the Claim or otherwise appear in this proceeding. As explained more fully below, a decision on default is issued in this case and Claimant is awarded reparations in the amount of \$7,576.56, plus interest.

II. PROCEDURAL HISTORY

On May 26, 2026, the Office of the Secretary (“OS”) of the FMC received the Claim for informal adjudication. On June 11, 2026, the Secretary of the FMC issued a Notice of Filing of Small Claims Complaint and Assignment (“Notice”), and sent the Notice, together with a copy

¹ Pursuant to 46 C.F.R. § 502.304(g), this decision will become final unless the Commission elects to review it within 30 days of service.

of the Claim, by FedEx to Respondent's address on file for service of process with the Secretary of State of New York, where Respondent is registered as a limited liability company.² The Notice advised Respondent that it was required to file a response to the Claim by July 6, 2026, and indicate whether it consents to the adjudication of the Claim under the informal procedures provided at Subpart S of the Commission's Rules of Practice and Procedure (46 C.F.R. § 502.301-305) ("Rules"). FedEx successfully delivered the Notice and Claim on June 12, 2026, as evidenced by the FedEx proof of delivery for tracking number 872971420446.

Respondent did not file a response and therefore did not refuse to consent to the informal procedures.

On July 12, 2026, Claimant submitted a "Motion for Leave to Amend Complaint to Reflect Final Costs." ("Motion"). Despite the title of the Motion, Claimant did not purport to amend the Claim, but rather submitted further documentation to reflect the final shipping costs incurred.

On July 22, 2026, the Chief Administrative Law Judge assigned this proceeding to the undersigned Small Claims Officer ("SCO") for adjudication under the informal procedures for small claims.

On July 24, 2026, an Order for Respondent to Show Cause ("OSC") was issued, requiring Respondent to show cause by July 31, 2026, why a default judgment should not be entered against it for failing to file a response to the Claim. The OSC warned Respondent that a failure to respond could cause Respondent to be deemed in default and reparations to be awarded to Claimant. The OSC was successfully delivered to Respondent's address on July 27, 2026, as evidenced by FedEx proof of delivery for tracking number 874840598984. Respondent did not respond to the OSC.

On August 3, 2026, a Request for Information ("RFI") was issued to Claimant. Claimant submitted a response to the RFI, along with supporting documentation, on August 3, 2026. ("C. RFI Resp.").

III. PRELIMINARY ISSUES

A. Jurisdiction

The Shipping Act provides that a "person may file with the Federal Maritime Commission a sworn complaint alleging a violation of this part." 46 U.S.C. § 41301(a). Pursuant to this provision, the Commission has exclusive jurisdiction over a complaint alleging that a respondent committed an act prohibited by the Shipping Act. *See Anchor Shipping Co. v. Aliança Navegação E Logística Ltda.*, Dkt. No. 02-04, 30 S.R.R. 991, 2006 WL 2007808, at *11 (FMC May 10, 2006); *see also Cargo One, Inc. v. COSCO Container Lines Co. Ltd.*, Dkt. No. 99-24, 28 S.R.R. 1635, 1645, 2000 WL 1648961, at *15 (FMC Oct. 31, 2000). Here, the Commission has jurisdiction because the Claim alleges a violation of section 41102(c) of the Shipping Act.

² <https://apps.dos.ny.gov/publicInquiry/EntityDisplay> (last visited Aug. 25, 2026).

It appears that Respondent may have ceased its business operations. Respondent stopped communicating with Claimant, no longer maintains its website,³ had its FMC ocean transportation intermediary license revoked on October 19, 2025, for failure to maintain a bond,⁴ and has failed to respond in this proceeding. Respondent is a registered limited liability company in the State of New York under the entity name Transparent Logistics LLC, with an assumed name of Transparent International.⁵ The State of New York Division of Corporations official website shows that Respondent last filed a Biennial Statement on September 19, 2025, and reflects a current entity status of “active.”⁶ Thus, even if Respondent has ceased business operations, it does not appear that Respondent has legally dissolved. Pursuant to New York Business Corporation Law § 1006, even if Respondent legally dissolves, it “may ... be sued in all courts and participate in actions and proceedings, whether judicial, administrative, arbitral or otherwise, in its corporate name, and process may be served by or upon it” and the “dissolution of a corporation shall not affect any remedy available to or against such corporation, its directors, officers or shareholders for any right or claim existing or any liability incurred before such dissolution.” N.Y. Bus. Corp. Law § 1006(a)(4) and (b).

B. Default

Respondent has failed to respond in this proceeding by failing to file a response to the Claim and failing to respond to the OSC. “Under such circumstances, it is customary for the Commission as well as courts to find that a defaulting respondent has admitted the well-pled allegations both as to the specific violations of law alleged and as to the specific money damages alleged.” *Smart Garments v. Worldlink Logix Servs.*, Dkt. No. 10-11, 2011 WL 7144015 (ALJ Oct. 31, 2011) (citations omitted), *aff’d* 2013 WL 9808693 (FMC Sep. 12, 2023). “The presiding officer may issue a default judgment, a cease and desist order, or other just ruling against a party that fails to respond to a properly served order or pleading.” *Smart Garments*, 2013 WL 9808693 (FMC Sep. 12, 2023), at *2 (citations omitted).⁷

Here, Respondent was properly served the Claim at its address for service of process on file with the New York Secretary of State.⁸ Despite being properly served, Respondent did not respond to the Claim, nor did it respond to the OSC. By failing to contest the allegations against it, the allegations are deemed admitted.

³ The moving estimate and shipping invoices issued by Respondent include Respondent’s website <https://www.movingtransparent.com>. (Claim at Exs. 1, 2). The website is no longer active and displays the message “Site Currently Unavailable.” <https://www.movingtransparent.com> (last visited Aug 25, 2026).

⁴ <https://www.fmc.gov/wp-content/uploads/2025/12/2025.10-October-OTI-License-Revocations-and-Surrenders.pdf> (last visited Aug. 25, 2026).

⁵ See <https://apps.dos.ny.gov/publicInquiry/AssumedNameHistory> (last visited Aug. 25, 2026).

⁶ See <https://apps.dos.ny.gov/publicInquiry/FilingHistory> (last visited Aug. 25, 2026).

⁷ Although not directly applicable to the informal procedures in small claims proceedings, Commission Rule 65 provides that a party to a proceeding may be deemed to be in default if that party fails to answer or otherwise to defend the proceeding. 46 C.F.R. § 502.65(a)(2). When a party is found to be in default, the presiding officer may issue a decision on default upon consideration of the record, including the complaint. *Id.* § 502.65(b). Decisions on default have also been issued in small claims proceedings. See, e.g., *Fenton v. Rocky Mountain Overseas*, Dkt. No. 1965(I) (SCO Feb. 17, 2021), *admin. final* Mar. 22, 2021.

⁸ See <https://apps.dos.ny.gov/publicInquiry/EntityDisplay> (last visited Aug. 25, 2026).

IV. FINDINGS OF FACT

A. Parties

1. Claimant Heather Meleka Wilson is an individual currently residing in the United Kingdom. (Claim at ¶ VI).
2. Respondent Transparent International/Transparent Logistics Inc. is a limited liability corporation registered in the State of New York with an active entity status. (Claim at ¶ II; <https://apps.dos.ny.gov/publicInquiry/EntityDisplay> (last visited Aug. 25, 2026)). Respondent's registered entity name is Transparent Logistics LLC, with an assumed name of Transparent International. (<https://apps.dos.ny.gov/publicInquiry/AssumedNameHistory> (last visited Aug. 25, 2026)).
3. Respondent held itself out as a company providing "door-to-door international transport of personal effects and household goods." (Claim at ¶ III.1).
4. Respondent's web address is www.movingtransparent.com. (Claim at Ex. A, p. 5).⁹ Respondent's website is no longer active and displays the message "Site Currently Unavailable." (www.movingtransparent.com (last visited Aug. 25, 2026)).
5. Respondent was an FMC licensed ocean transportation intermediary until its license was revoked on October 19, 2025, for failure to maintain a bond. (<https://www.fmc.gov/wp-content/uploads/2025/12/2025.10-October-OTI-License-Revocations-and-Surrenders.pdf>).

B. Shipping Agreement

6. On January 31, 2025, Respondent provided Claimant an "International Moving Estimate" for a "Professional Door to Door Move" of household goods, to be shipped by "Sea," from Virginia Beach, Virginia to Birmingham, United Kingdom. (Claim at Ex. A, pp. 5-8). The total estimate amount was \$6,770.00, excluding cargo insurance. (*Id.*). The estimate included Respondents "OTI/NVOCC" registration number "026891N." (*Id.*).
7. On March 14, 2025, claimant paid Respondent a deposit totaling \$677.00. (Claim at Ex. A, p. 9).
8. On July 9, 2025, Respondent emailed Claimant stating that the final volume of the cargo was less than originally booked and that Respondent would provide "a new, more economical price based on the revised measurements." (Claim at Ex. A, p. 14).
9. On July 15, 2025, Respondent issued an "International Sea Order for Service." (Claim at Ex. A, pp. 16-19). The order reflected a move date of July 25, 2025, and a move cost of

⁹ The Claim and attached exhibits are not paginated. The page numbers throughout this decision refer to the PDF file page number.

\$6,520.00, with a deposit received of \$677.00. (*Id.*). The order also included Respondent's "OTI-NVOCC" number "026891N." (*Id.*).

10. On July 23, 2025, Respondent issued an invoice to Claimant billing \$6,520.00. (Claim at Ex. A, p. 29). The invoice included Respondent's "OTI-NVOCC" number "026891N." (*Id.*).
11. By check dated July 21, 2025, Claimant paid Respondent \$5,843.00 for the shipment. (Claim at Ex. A, p. 30). With the deposit, Claimant paid Respondent a total of \$6,520.00 for the shipment. (*Id.* at pp. 9, 30).
12. Also by check dated July 21, 2025, Claimant paid Respondent \$1,056.56 for a cargo insurance policy with Worldwide Transit Insurance Brokers ("WTI"). (Claim at Ex. A, pp. 34-43).
13. On July 25, 2025, Respondent's designated origin agent collected the household goods from Claimant. (Claim at ¶ III.1).
14. Respondent represented to Claimant that "the shipment would be processed within an approximate 16-week window." (Claim at Ex. A, p. 50).

C. Respondent's Failure to Ship the Household Goods

15. On March 12, 2026, Claimant emailed Respondent to "formally address the ongoing and unacceptable delay regarding [the] shipment from the U.S. to the U.K." (Claim at Ex. A, p. 50). Claimant stated in the email message, "I have not been able to reach you or any customer service representative at your phone numbers, or had my voice message returned." (*Id.*). Claimant requested that the cargo be loaded onto a vessel within 14 days and confirmation of the vessel name, bill of lading number, and estimated date of arrival. (*Id.*).
16. Respondent ceased all communication. (Claim at ¶ III.3.).
17. Claimant later discovered that the household goods were never shipped and instead remained in a warehouse in Brooklyn, New York. (Claim at Ex. A, p. 51).

D. Claimant's Mitigation Efforts

18. On March 31, 2026, Claimant sent an email to WTI, the cargo insurance provider, stating:

I am filing a claim, because I have not received my goods from Transparent International.

On July 25, 2025, Transparent International collected my cargo from Virginia for door-to-door shipment to the UK. Despite providing the delivery address on Oct 24, 2025, my goods remain in the US over eight

months later. My point of contact has left the company, and management is unresponsive to calls and emails.

(Claim at Ex. B, pp. 54-55).

19. WTI replied to Claimant on March 31, 2026, stating:

Sorry for the challenges with your mover.

Note the insurance does not cover delay in delivery. For claim, it would need to be confirmed by insurers that your shipment is indeed lost and not just delayed.

That said, you are free to file a claim per link below & start process - our surveyor should be able to assist you in locating your shipment.

(Claim at Ex. B, p. 55).

20. On April 1, 2026, WTI emailed Claimant to confirm the appointment of a loss adjuster for the claim filed by Claimant. (Claim at Ex. B, p. 58).
21. On April 1, 2026, a claims specialist appointed by WTI emailed Claimant stating, in relevant part:

Your claim has been successfully opened under number 2026-373.

....

We are currently working with surveyors who are actively assisting in locating and assessing shipments impacted by Transparent International. I will be forwarding your claim details to them as part of this ongoing process.

At this time, investigations are still ongoing, please rest assured that your claim is being actively reviewed.

(Claim at Ex. B, p. 54).

22. On April 10, 2026, a loss adjuster appointed by WTI emailed Claimant, stating: "Please note that it has been established there are a significant number of consignments located in storage at a facility operated by Transparent International in Brooklyn, NY. We are currently awaiting further instructions from Insurers to determine options to identify those consignments retained at the facility and release of the same." (*Id.* at pp. 59-60).
23. On May 1, 2026, Claimant emailed a third-party international moving company requesting a quote to pick up Claimant's household goods from the warehouse in Brooklyn, New York and ship the goods to Claimant in the United Kingdom. (Claim at Ex. B, p. 66). On May 4, 2026, the third-party moving company responded with a quote of \$5,625. (*Id.* at p. 67).

24. On May 4, 2026, Claimant emailed the loss adjuster appointed by WTI. (Claim at Ex. B, p. 62). The message stated: “I received a quote from [a third-party international moving company] and wanted to confirm if the insurance with WTI will still be honoured should I proceed with the service.” (*Id.*) The loss adjuster responded on May 5, 2026, stating “we will forward your coverage inquiry” to WTI.
25. The record does not contain any further communication with WTI or its appointed loss adjuster after May 4, 2026. The RFI issued in this matter asked Claimant to provide an update on the current status of any cargo insurance claim and whether any cargo insurance payment has been received. (RFI at No. 3). In response, Claimant declared under penalty of perjury that: “Claimant has not filed or received payment for a cargo insurance claim. Per WTI, cargo insurance claims apply to lost or damaged goods; because Claimant’s shipment is neither lost nor damaged, no insurance claim could be made.” (C. RFI Resp. at No. 3).
26. Claimant ultimately paid the third-party moving company \$5,589.04 to retrieve the household goods from the warehouse in New York and ship them to the United Kingdom. (Motion at pp. 1, 3). Claimant also paid an additional fee of £288.00 for delivery of her household goods to a third-floor unit. (Motion at pp. 1, 4-7).
27. Claimant also filed a bond claim with Respondent’s surety Hudson Insurance Company (“Hudson”), pursuant to 46 U.S.C. § 40902(b) and 46 C.F.R. § 515.23. (Claim at ¶ III.5). On April 28, 2026, the firm representing Hudson issued a letter to Claimant denying the bond claim on the grounds that there is neither a judgement against Respondent nor a settlement. (Claim at Ex. 3, p. 97). The letter states in relevant part:

The bond was issued pursuant to the Shipping Act of 1984, 46 U.S.C. 40101-41309. The condition of the bond is that the penalty amount is available:

“to pay any judgment or any settlement made pursuant to a claim under 46 CFR 515.23 for damages against the Principal arising from the Principal’s transportation-related activities or order for reparations issued pursuant to section 11 of the Shipping Act (46 U.S.C. 41301-41302, 41305-41307(a)) or any penalty assessed against the Principal pursuant to section 13 of the Shipping Act (46 U.S.C. 41107-41109).”

The Proof of Claim seeks recovery under the surety’s bond. After reviewing your claim and the documents submitted, the surety found that the condition of the bond has not been met. There is no indication that a judgment against the Principal has been obtained, nor has a settlement been made as to your claim, pursuant to 46 CFR 515.23. Therefore, based on the language of the bond, the surety must respectfully deny your claim.

(*Id.*).

V. ANALYSIS

A. Violation of Section 41102(c)

Section 41102(c) of the Shipping Act states that a “common carrier, marine terminal operator, or ocean transportation intermediary may not fail to establish, observe, and enforce just and reasonable regulations and practices relating to or connected with receiving, handling, storing, or delivering property.” 46 U.S.C. § 41102(c). The elements of a section 41102(c) claim are that:

- (1) The respondent is an ocean common carrier, marine terminal operator, or ocean transportation intermediary;
- (2) The claimed acts or omissions of the regulated entity are occurring on a normal, customary, and continuous basis;
- (3) The practice or regulation relates to or is connected with receiving, handling, storing, or delivering property;
- (4) The practice or regulation is unjust or unreasonable; and
- (5) The practice or regulation is the proximate cause of the claimed loss.

46 C.F.R. § 545.4.

Here, Claimant’s allegations, supported by evidence submitted into the record, establish that Respondent violated section 41102(c). With respect to the first element, Respondent was a licensed ocean transportation intermediary with the FMC at the time Respondent accepted payment for an international shipment of Claimant’s household goods. Moreover, Respondent held itself out as a company arranging international ocean transportation of household goods from the United States to foreign destinations. Accordingly, the first element is met.

With respect to the second element, Respondent’s conduct was not an isolated incident, but rather the continuous manner in which Respondent was conducting business. *See Interpretive Rule, Shipping Act of 1984*, 83 Fed. Reg. 64478, 64479 (Dec. 17, 2018) (a violation requires a showing that “the unreasonable regulation or practice was the normal, customary, often repeated, systematic, uniform, habitual, and continuous manner in which the regulated common carrier was conducting business”). To date, the Commission has received at least four other complaints filed against Respondent from different claimants alleging the same pattern of accepting payment for an international shipment of household goods, and then failing to ship or deliver the household goods and ceasing communication. On the same date as the issuance of the Initial Decision in this matter, Initial Decisions are also being issued in those four separate cases finding that Respondent engaged in the same unreasonable practice.¹⁰

¹⁰ Docket Nos. 2059(I), 2061(I), 2063(I), and 2067(I).

The third element is also met. Respondent's conduct related to the pickup, shipment, and delivery of Claimant's household goods from Virginia to the United Kingdom—thus relating to the “receiving, handling, storing, or delivering property.” 46 C.F.R. § 545.4(c).

Respondent's conduct was patently unreasonable, as Respondent accepted payment for an international shipment of Claimant's household goods, but then abandoned the household goods in a warehouse, never shipped the household goods, and ceased communicating with Claimant. Accordingly, the fourth element is met.

Finally, the last element is met, as Respondent's conduct proximately caused Claimant to suffer losses—Claimant paid Respondent for a shipment that Respondent never performed.

B. Reparations

Claimant seeks reparations in the amount of \$13,752.6 plus interest, which consists of: \$7,576.56 paid to Respondent (including \$1,056.56 paid for the cargo insurance policy with WTI); \$5,589.04 paid to the third-party international moving company to recover the household goods from the warehouse in New York and ship them to the United Kingdom; the additional £288.00 fee for delivery to a third-floor unit; \$176 for the FMC filing fee; and \$25.00 for the notary public fee. (Claim; Motion).

Pursuant to section 41301, a “complainant may seek reparations for an injury to the complainant caused by [a] violation” of the Shipping Act. 46 U.S.C. § 41301(a). “If the complaint was filed within [three years after the claim accrues], the Federal Maritime Commission shall direct the payment of reparations to the complainant for *actual* injury caused by a violation.” *Id.* § 41305(b) (emphasis added). Accordingly, “[r]eparations will only be awarded based on actual damages.” *Color Brands, LLC v. AAF Logistics, Inc.*, Dkt. No. 22-18, 2024 WL 4034609, at *2 (ALJ Aug. 27, 2024), *admin. final* Sep. 27, 2024. “The term ‘actual damages,’ ... means those recoverable from a wrongdoer as compensation for the actual loss or injuries sustained by reason of the wrongdoing.” *California Shipping Line, Inc. v. Yangming Marine Transport Corp.*, Dkt. No. 88-15, 1990 WL 427466, at *23 (FMC Oct. 19, 1990). “That does not require absolute precision but does require evidence sufficient to reasonably infer the actual loss sustained.” *MAVL Capital Inc. v. Marine Transport Logistics, Inc.*, Dkt. No. 16-16, 2022 WL 2209421, at *3 (FMC June 10, 2022). The Commission allows the adjudicator discretion in determining the amount of reparations. *Samsung Electronics America, Inc. v. SM Line Corp.*, Dkt. No. 23-01, 2026 WL 2427726, at *10 (FMC Aug. 13, 2026). In awarding reparations for actual injury, the Commission considers whether the claimant “has received something it wanted” and avoids an award of reparations that would cause a claimant to “unfairly receiv[e] a windfall.” *CMI Distribution, Inc. v. Service By Air, Inc.*, Dkt. No. 17-05, 2021 WL 3367603, at *17 (FMC Jul. 26, 2021); *see also* *TPG Pressure, Inc. v. Omni Logistics LLC*, Dkt. No. 22-31, 2024 WL 4226354, at *42 (ALJ Sept. 12, 2024) (calculating a reparations award that “prevent[ed] the shipper from unfairly receiving a windfall”); *Carrier Int’l Corp. v. Waterman Steamship Corp.*, Dkt. No. 85-1, 1985 WL 148944, at *4 (FMC Dec. 30, 1985) (reversing ALJ’s award of reparations because it would “result[] in an unanticipated and unwarranted windfall to Complainant if reparations [were] awarded.”).

Here, Respondent's violation proximately caused injury to Claimant in the form of the \$7,576.56 that Claimant paid to Respondent for the shipment that Respondent never performed. Claimant also seeks the amount subsequently paid to a different international moving company to retrieve the household goods from the warehouse in New York and ship them to the United Kingdom for delivery to Claimant's residence. But to award reparations both for the amount Claimant paid to Respondent, and the amount subsequently paid to another international moving company to ship her household goods, would result in a double recovery. In other words, by awarding reparations for the amount paid to Respondent, Claimant is placed back in the position she would have been in had she never entered into a shipping agreement with Respondent.

Claimant additionally seeks reasonable costs associated with pursuing the Claim, such as the FMC filing fee and the notary public fee. However, "[t]he Commission is authorized only to award 'reasonable attorney fees,' 46 U.S.C. § 41305, a term that does not include 'costs.'" *Cornell v. Princess Cruise Lines, Ltd.*, Dkt. No. 13-02, 2013 WL 9808684 at *62 (ALJ Jul. 23, 2013) (citing *Global Transporte Oceanico S.A. v. Coler Ocean Independent Lines Co.*, 28 S.R.R. 1162, 1163 n.5 (ALJ 1999)), *rev'd on other grounds*, 2014 WL 5316340 (FMC Aug. 28, 2014). Therefore, the request for costs must be denied.

It is important to note that if Claimant were to receive a payment from the cargo insurance provider WTI, such payment should be offset from the reparations award. Without an offset, Claimant would receive an unanticipated windfall, placing Claimant in a better position than bargained for. In response to the RFI, Claimant avers that no claim was filed with the cargo insurance provider. (C. RFI Resp. at No. 3). However, the record appears to contradict this statement—Claimant has produced emails with WTI and its assigned loss adjustor which reflect that Claimant filed a cargo insurance claim with WTI and communicated with both WTI and the loss adjustor regarding the cargo insurance claim. The record does not, however, reflect any settlement or payment of the claim. In order to avoid a potential double recovery, Claimant shall inform Respondent's bond surety in the event Claimant's cargo insurance claim is settled or any payment is received.

Finally, "actual injury" includes "the loss of interest at commercial rates compounded from the date of injury." 46 U.S.C. § 41305(a). It is reasonable to consider the date of injury as the date Complainant paid Respondent for the shipment. The record reflects that Claimant paid Respondent a deposit on March 14, 2025, and the remaining sum on July 21, 2025. As absolute precision is not required, I find a reasonable date of injury to be March 14, 2025. Accordingly, March 14, 2025, shall be considered the date of injury for purposes of calculating the interest due.

VI. CONCLUSION

It is hereby **ORDERED** by default that Respondent violated 46 U.S.C. § 41102(c). It is

FURTHER ORDERED that Respondent must pay reparations in the amount of \$7,576.56, plus interest calculated from March 14, 2025.

SO ORDERED

Jamie L.
Mendelson -S

Digitally signed by
Jamie L. Mendelson

Jamie L. Mendelson
Small Claims Officer